

NATALIA TARITA

Platform Engineer | Chicago, IL | U.S. Permanent Resident

nataliatarita95@gmail.com · 872-400-1026 · linkedin.com/in/nataliatarita · nately-1995.github.io

SUMMARY

Platform Engineer with 5+ years building and operating production AWS and Kubernetes infrastructure. Took a 20-service platform off manually-pushed deployments and onto GitOps, removed production deployment credentials from CI, and built the AI review layer that flags risky infrastructure changes before they merge — with a human required to approve every production write.

EXPERIENCE

Platform Engineer · Chowly

Chicago, IL · Nov 2023 – Present

Restaurant technology connecting POS systems, online ordering, and delivery platforms.

- Migrated 20 services to Argo CD across 3 EKS environments, removing production deployment credentials from CI and making Git the single source of desired state for the cluster.
- Built AI-assisted Terraform review into the pull-request pipeline — deterministic checks first, then contextual analysis for IAM and network risk. It flagged a security-group rule widening internal access from 10.1.0.0/16 to 10.0.0.0/8 after an initial human review had accepted it.
- Moved 20+ EKS workloads from shared AWS access to per-service identities with IRSA and least-privilege IAM, retiring ~25 long-lived access keys.
- Cut AWS spend ~18% (~\$60–80K/year) through EC2 right-sizing and storage cleanup, then added monitoring after the first round of savings started creeping back.
- Replaced SSH access to 8 EC2 services with immutable Packer images rolled through ASG refreshes, removing SSH from the normal production deployment path.

DevOps Engineer · Grubhub

Chicago, IL · Jul 2021 – Nov 2023

High-volume online ordering and delivery platform.

- Diagnosed a post-release CPU-throttling regression, rolled back to restore service, then corrected resource requests and limits, reviewed HPA behavior against workload demand, and added throttling alerts to surface similar regressions earlier.
- Carried the on-call pager for AWS and Kubernetes, tuning alerts until the rotation paged on real problems instead of noise.
- Built the Prometheus/Grafana/CloudWatch observability layer used during incident triage to distinguish application failures from infrastructure failures.
- Built reusable Terraform modules that became the provisioning standard across 10+ services, cutting environment setup from days to hours.
- Automated container delivery for 15+ services with Jenkins, Docker, Helm, and Kubernetes, replacing manual release steps with a repeatable pipeline.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Kubernetes	AWS (EKS, EC2, ECR, VPC, IAM, S3, RDS, Route 53, CloudWatch) · Helm · HPA · RBAC · IRSA · Docker
Delivery & IaC	Terraform · Argo CD · GitOps · GitHub Actions · Jenkins · Packer
Observability	Prometheus · Grafana · Alertmanager · CloudWatch · Incident Response
Security	IRSA · least-privilege IAM · Kubernetes RBAC · Secrets Manager
AI & Automation	Claude Code · MCP · Python · Bash

CERTIFICATION

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)

The Linux Foundation / CNCF · Credential ID LF-foco5c3jzm

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